English economist Thomas Malthus was the godson of philosophers David Hume and Jean-Jacques Rousseau, and went on to study at Cambridge University. He became a clergyman in the Church of England, but is most famous for his study of the connection between population growth and poverty. In 1805, he became the first ever Professor of Political Economy.

Alfred Marshall (1842–1924)

One of the most influential British economists and a founder of the neoclassical school, Marshall brought a scientific method to the study of economics. In his book *Principles of Economics*, he gave a comprehensive explanation of all aspects of the subject, and it became a standard textbook for students for more than 50 years. He taught at the universities of Bristol and Cambridge, and John Maynard Keynes was among the many students influenced by him.

Karl Marx (1818–1883)

Carl Menger (1840–1921)

Born in Galicia, present-day Poland, Menger was a professor of economics at the University of Vienna, where he helped to develop the theory of marginal utility, explaining the value of goods in terms of each additional unit. His work on this led to a split from the prevailing German economic thinkers, and the founding of the Austrian school of economics with his colleagues Eugen Böhm von Bawerk, Friedrich von Wieser, and others.

John Stuart Mill (1806–1873)

Mill was born into a prominent English family of thinkers, and went on to become a philosopher, politician, and campaigner as well as an economist. His theories regarding the freedom of the individual from state intervention formed the basis for British 19th-century political and economic liberalism. He was a Member of Parliament in the 1860s, and was outspoken in his views about social justice. He was also an opponent of slavery, and with his wife Harriet Taylor he campaigned for women's rights.

Hyman Minsky (1919–1996)

Best known for his description of financial crises, and the "Minsky moment" when a crash becomes inevitable, Hyman Minsky was a professor of economics at Washington University, St. Louis. His main interest was in the ups and downs of economies that can lead to "boom and bust." Influenced by J. M. Keynes, he recommended government intervention in financial markets.

Ludwig von Mises (1881–1973)

A leading economist of the Austrian School, von Mises studied under Eugen Böhm von Bawerk at the University of Vienna. He left Vienna for Geneva after the Nazis came to power in the 1930s, and eventually settled in New York, where he taught at the university. His anti-socialist economic theories were a major influence on Friedrich Hayek and the neoliberal economists in the US during the second half of the 20th century.